

RULE: كان (was) and its sisters: after them the PREDICATE takes FATHA (accusative).

The 9 Sisters of كان

Arabic	Meaning	Example
كان	was	كان رجلًا صالحًا — He was a righteous man
صار	became	صار عالمًا — He became a scholar
صار	became (in morning)	صار ثريًا — He became rich
صار	became (in evening)	صار فقيرًا — He became poor
كان	still is/was	كان صادقًا — He is still truthful
لم يكن	is not	لم يكن عالمًا — He is not a scholar
قضى	spent the night	قضى ليلته خائفًا — He spent the night afraid

RULE: كان with Allah's attributes = timeless quality: كان غفورًا رحيمًا
كان غفورًا رحيمًا = Allah is Ever-Forgiving, Ever-Merciful.

★ The predicate of كان takes fatha: كان عالمًا (not كان عالِمًا)

★ كان... (Allah was/is...) appears 70+ times in the Quran with divine attributes

★ كان = still is — very useful: كان أتعلم = I am still learning